



SKILLFORGE AI

The Plumber AI Playbook

Seven workflows from the 11 pm emergency call to the repipe quote — for techs, service managers, and shop owners.

WHAT IT IS

Seven copy-paste AI workflows that cover the full arc of a plumbing job: the 11 pm emergency dispatch text, the 20-minute three-tier water-heater quote, the spring maintenance-plan cadence, the same-day diagnostic report, the 30-day warranty check-in, the 14-day review request, and the multi-day repipe proposal — plus three bonus prompts for confirmations, missed appointments, and review replies.

WHO IT'S FOR

Plumbing techs, service managers, dispatchers, and shop owners — anyone whose evenings disappear into texts, quotes, and follow-ups after the wrench work is done.

WHAT YOU NEED

Any general AI chat assistant (ChatGPT or Claude), your own diagnostic fee and rate sheet, and about ten minutes to run the first workflow. No new software, no dispatch platform, no tech background.

HOW IT WORKS

Every workflow ships the same way: the tool, what to paste in, the ready-to-paste prompt, what the output should look like, a worked example, and the checks to run before it reaches a customer. AI drafts; you decide — every price, date, and promise comes from your sheet, never from the tool.



SkillForge AI — practical AI playbooks for working trades



What's inside

How to use this playbook

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Workflow 2 — Water-heater quote: the 20-minute build

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The week-one quick start

Read it in order the first time — the workflows follow the way jobs actually flow. After that, the week-one quick start at the end is the chapter you'll live on.

How to use this playbook

This book is not about the work under the sink. That part is yours, and no chatbot is holding a wrench. It is about the work *around* the job: the after-hours texts, the quotes, the schedule confirms, the follow-ups, the review asks. That is the stuff that eats your evenings, and it is the stuff an AI assistant is genuinely good at drafting.

Inside are seven workflows that cover the full arc of a plumbing job — from the emergency call that comes in at 11 pm to the multi-day repipe proposal signed at the kitchen table. Every workflow ships the same way: the tool you use, a short how-to for what to paste in, the ready-to-paste prompt, what the output should look like, a worked example, the checks to run before anything reaches a customer, and the guardrails.

What you need

- Any general AI chat assistant — ChatGPT or Claude, the one you already open. Every prompt in this book runs on either.
- Your own numbers. Your diagnostic fee, your rate sheet, your warranty terms. The prompts have brackets where your numbers go; the AI never

invents them.

- Ten quiet minutes to run the first workflow. After that, each one runs in the time it takes to paste.

The one rule that matters

AI drafts; you decide. Every quote, every text, every price gets your eyes before it goes to a customer. The tool does the typing; the license, the judgment, and the reputation stay yours.

Never paste a customer's private details into an AI tool. First names and job descriptions only — no full addresses in prompts you would not read aloud, no payment details, no account numbers. The prompts in this book are written to work with the minimum: a first name, an issue, a time, a price you already set.

How to work through the book

Read it in order the first time. The workflows are arranged the way jobs actually flow: the call, the quote, the plan, the report, the follow-up, the review, the big project. After that, the quick-start chapter at the end is the page you will live on — it lists which prompt to reach for at which moment, and it carries three bonus prompts for the moments the seven workflows do not cover.

Start with one workflow this week. The emergency dispatch is the fastest win if after-hours calls run your life. The water-heater quote is the fastest win if you price at the kitchen table.



Workflow 1 — Emergency call: the 11 pm same-night dispatch

A two-step workflow that responds to a weekend emergency call with a calm text, a triage call, and the price anchor the tech reads out at the door. Estimated time to run: about 8 minutes per call, most of it the triage call itself.

The tool

ChatGPT or Claude. Keep whichever one you use open in a pinned tab or on the truck phone — at 11 pm you do not want to be hunting for a login.

How to run it

1. Open the prompt the moment the after-hours call comes in.
2. Paste the call detail: first name, issue (leak vs clog vs no hot water vs sewer backup), and the address for your own dispatch notes.
3. Replace the placeholders with your real ETA and your real after-hours diagnostic fee.
4. Send the text within 10 minutes, then call the on-call tech with the same details.

The prompt

PROMPT — Same-night emergency dispatch text

You are a plumbing service manager running the after-hours emergency dispatch. Generate a 3-sentence SMS under 160 characters for the caller below. Sentence 1: opens with the caller's first name and names what is not working in plain English ([LEAK TYPE], no hot water, sewer backup, etc.). Sentence 2: anchors the next step — the on-call tech is on the way with a specific ETA, and the after-hours diagnostic fee that holds the price no matter what the tech finds at the door. Sentence 3: a single yes/no question about whether an adult is home to let the tech in. No exclamation points, no urgency filler, no "we appreciate your call." Caller: [CALLER FIRST NAME]. Issue: [LEAK TYPE]. ETA: [TECH ETA]. Fee: [DIAGNOSTIC FEE].



What you get

A dispatch text under 160 characters that names the problem, anchors the fee before the truck rolls, and ends on one yes/no question the homeowner can answer while they are finding the shutoff.

Worked example

Sample inputs — swap in your own numbers: Caller: Dana. Issue: burst supply line, water shut off at the main. ETA: 45 minutes. Fee: your standard after-hours diagnostic fee. A good output reads like this: "Dana, we've got your burst supply line logged. Our on-call tech is heading out now, about 45 minutes, and tonight's diagnostic fee is [your fee] — that price holds whatever he finds. Is an adult home to let him in?" Short, calm, no hype. The fee is anchored before the door opens, which is what keeps the doorstep conversation easy.

Before you send

- The ETA is one you can actually hit. An AI will happily print any number you give it; the customer remembers the one you sent.
- The fee matches tonight's real after-hours rate — not yesterday's, not the daytime rate.
- First name only in the prompt. The address stays in your dispatch system, not in the chat.

Guardrails

Treat the output as a draft and keep a human approval step. Do not paste passwords, payment details, clinical notes, or government identifiers into any AI tool. If the caller mentions gas smell or electrical contact with water, skip the text workflow and follow your emergency protocol and local code first — the draft can wait, the dispatch cannot.

Workflow 2 — Water-heater quote: the 20-minute build

A two-step prompt that turns the kitchen-table review after a water-heater assessment into a fixed-price replacement quote with three option tiers. Estimated time to run: about 20 minutes per assessment, including your own look at the numbers.

One take-it-or-leave-it number gets shopped against the next guy. Three options — repair or basic replacement, the recommended unit, the premium upgrade — let the customer choose their comfort level instead of arguing about your price. You check the numbers; the AI does the writing.

The tool

ChatGPT or Claude, on the tablet or phone you already carry into the home.

How to run it

1. Open the prompt at the kitchen-table review, right after the assessment.
2. Paste the facts you confirmed: fuel type (gas vs electric), household size, existing unit age, venting and space constraints.
3. Replace the placeholders and add your installed prices for each tier from your own rate sheet.
4. Cut the output into your quote form before you leave the table.

The prompt

**PROMPT — Three-tier water-heater quote**

You are a plumbing service manager pricing a water-heater replacement. Below is the kitchen-table review. Generate a three-tier quote as a 3-row table (Tier | System | Includes | Price | Best For). Cover, in order: (1) Good — a basic tank unit matched to the home's fuel type, standard vent, basic warranty — for the budget-anchored homeowner; (2) Better — a larger or high-efficiency unit matched to the household size, extended warranty — for the homeowner who named utility cost as a goal; (3) Best — a tankless or premium unit with leak detection and auto-shutoff valve, full warranty — for the homeowner who asked about long-term costs. Numbers, no filler adjectives. Only use the prices I give you — if a price is missing, write "price to confirm" instead of inventing one. Assessment notes: [PASTE NOTES]. My prices: [GOOD PRICE], [BETTER PRICE], [BEST PRICE].

What you get

A clean three-row quote the homeowner can compare across comfort levels instead of across competitors — with your prices, in your numbers, and a "Best For" column that does the explaining for you.

Worked example

Sample inputs: 40-gallon gas tank, 12 years old, family of four, homeowner asked about the gas bill. Good: same-size standard tank, basic warranty. Better: 50-gallon high-efficiency gas, extended warranty — matched to the utility-cost goal the homeowner raised. Best: tankless gas with Wi-Fi leak detector and auto-shutoff. Each row carries the installed price from your sheet. If you do not stock a tier or cannot confirm a price at the table, the prompt leaves it marked "price to confirm" — far better than a number you have to walk back tomorrow.

Before you send

- Fuel type, venting, and space limits are confirmed from the actual unit, not the homeowner's guess.
- Every price came from your sheet. The AI formats; it never prices.
- The warranty terms in each tier are the ones your shop actually honors.



Guardrails

Treat the output as a draft and keep a human approval step. Never let a generated quote promise a rebate, credit, or efficiency figure you have not verified for that specific model — if it is not in your notes, it does not go in the quote.



Workflow 3 — Maintenance plan: the spring flush cadence

A four-touch maintenance-plan renewal cadence that lands at the spring flush — mid-March through mid-April — before the homeowner schedules with the shop down the street. Estimated time to run: about 15 minutes to set up, then it runs per active plan.

The tool

ChatGPT or Claude to write the four touches once; your CRM or scheduling tool to queue them as a triggered sequence.

How to run it

1. Open the prompt 14 days before your spring target date.
2. Paste the seasonal check list for your plans (spring: water-heater flush, sump pump test, hose-bibb freeze check).
3. Replace the placeholders with your plan name and visit windows.
4. Queue the four touches in your CRM as one cadence per active plan household.

The prompt

PROMPT — Spring flush 4-touch cadence

You are a plumbing service manager running the spring maintenance-plan renewal cadence. Generate the 4-touch sequence as a 4-row table (Touch | Message | Single Ask). Cover, in order: (1) Spring remote-touch — a water-heater flush reminder, one paragraph under 120 words that opens with the spring date the homeowner can pin to the fridge, names the 3 things the tech will check on the visit (anode rod, pressure relief valve, sediment flush), closes with one yes/no question about keeping the same time slot from last fall; (2) Spring early-bird reminder under 100 words that opens with a 2-week advance window, names the 3 things the tech will check (sump pump test, hose-bibb freeze risk, water-heater anode check), closes with a yes/no slotting question; (3) Spring late-bird reminder under 80 words that names the date and the visit window with a 7-day hold; (4) Spring wrap-up email under 80 words that names the next visit window (summer or fall), no ask. Tone: direct, calm, no exclamation points, no filler. Plan: [MAINTENANCE PLAN NAME]. Spring window: [START DATE] to [END DATE].

What you get

Four touches written once and reused every spring: two value reminders, one hold-your-slot nudge, one no-ask wrap-up that sets up the next visit. Each touch ends on a single easy question or none at all.

Worked example

For a plan called "HomeCare Annual," first touch lands 14 days out: it names the flush date, the three checks, and asks one yes/no about last fall's slot. The wrap-up, sent after the window closes, simply names the fall visit window — a touch with no ask at all, which is the one customers remember as the shop that is not always selling.

Before you send

- The four touches are queued against real plan households only — nobody off-plan gets a renewal cadence.
- Dates and windows are your real spring calendar, with room for the callbacks the cadence will generate.
- The check lists match what your techs actually do on a plan visit.



Guardrails

Treat the output as a draft and keep a human approval step. Never promise a discount, priority status, or included repair in a generated touch unless it is written in the plan the customer bought.



Workflow 4 — Diagnostic report: the same-day email

A two-step prompt that turns your diagnostic findings into a same-day written report the homeowner can show the spouse, the inspector, or the insurance adjuster. Estimated time to run: about 12 minutes per visit.

You diagnosed the issue, quoted the fix, and the homeowner "needs to think about it." Most of those jobs go to whoever follows up first — and a written report in the inbox at dinner beats a business card on the fridge. This workflow makes that follow-up automatic.

The tool

ChatGPT or Claude, on the truck before you drive to the next job.

How to run it

1. Open the prompt in the truck, right after the visit.
2. Paste the diagnostic finding in plain words: one symptom, one cause, one fix.
3. Replace the placeholders and attach your three option prices from the visit.
4. Send before end of day, so the homeowner has the report in hand at dinner.

The prompt

PROMPT — Same-day diagnostic report

You are a plumbing service manager composing the same-day diagnostic report email. Below is the diagnostic. Generate a 250-word email that: (1) opens by naming the symptom the homeowner called about (a leak, a clog, no hot water, etc.); (2) names the single cause found in plain English, never a part code — "the fill valve is no longer sealing," not "part X is leaking"; (3) lists the three options the homeowner has today (the minimum repair, the recommended repair, the "while we are in there" add-on), with a one-line scope and the price I give you for each; (4) closes with one yes/no question about scheduling the recommended-repair visit this week. Tone: clear, calm, no exclamation points, no filler. Homeowner: [HOMEOWNER NAME]. Symptom: [SYMPTOM]. Cause: [CAUSE]. Fix: [FIX]. Prices: [MINIMUM], [RECOMMENDED], [ADD-ON].

What you get

A 250-word report a homeowner can forward without translating: what they called about, what you found, three priced options, one easy question. It is also your paper trail if the job is ever questioned later.

Worked example

Symptom: toilet runs every few minutes. Cause in plain English: the fill valve is no longer sealing. Options: minimum — fill-valve swap today; recommended — fill valve plus flapper and supply line while the tank is open; add-on — the second bathroom's original valves done in the same visit. Three lines, three prices, one yes/no about Thursday. The homeowner who "needs to ask the spouse" now forwards your email instead of paraphrasing you — that is the whole game.

Before you send

- The cause is stated in plain English and it is the cause you actually found — not the most likely one, the found one.
- Every price matches the numbers you quoted at the door.
- Nothing in the email diagnoses anything you did not inspect.



Guardrails

Treat the output as a draft and keep a human approval step. Do not paste passwords, payment details, or government identifiers. Never let a generated report speculate about insurance coverage or code compliance — if the homeowner needs that in writing, that comes from you or the inspector, not the draft.

Workflow 5 — Warranty follow-up: the 30-day check-in

A two-touch warranty follow-up that catches a callback issue within 30 days, while the work is still in warranty. Estimated time to run: about 5 minutes per follow-up.

The 30-day check-in does two jobs at once: it surfaces small problems while they are cheap to fix, and it opens the next conversation — the repipe, the second bathroom, the water-heater plan — from a position of service instead of sales.

The tool

ChatGPT or Claude; your CRM or a simple calendar tickler to flag day 30 on every closed job.

How to run it

1. Open the prompt at day 30 after the job closed.
2. Paste the repair type and one detail the homeowner will remember.
3. Replace the placeholders with their first name and the completion date.
4. Send the email the same day; log any reply against the original job.

The prompt

PROMPT — 30-day warranty check-in

You are a plumbing service manager running the 30-day warranty check-in. Below is the original repair. Generate a 150-word email that: (1) opens by naming the [REPAIR TYPE] and the date it was completed; (2) names the 3 things the homeowner should give a quick visual check (no drip, no slow drain, no pressure change on a specific fixture — whichever fits the repair); (3) closes with one yes/no question about whether they want the tech to swing by for the 30-day check. Tone: warm, no exclamation points. Homeowner: [HOMEOWNER NAME]. Repair: [REPAIR TYPE]. Detail: [ONE REMEMBERED DETAIL]. Completed: [DATE].



What you get

A 150-word email that puts your name back in front of the customer at exactly the moment a small drip would otherwise become someone else's emergency call — plus a yes/no that books the look-in.

Worked example

Repair: garbage disposal replaced under the kitchen sink on the 4th. Detail: the homeowner mentioned the sink drains slowly in the mornings. The check-in names the disposal, gives three visual checks (dry cabinet floor, no drip at the trap, drain speed back to normal), and asks one yes/no about a swing-by. If the drain is still slow, you hear about it on day 30 — not in a review on day 90.

Before you send

- The job is actually at or past day 30 and still inside your warranty window.
- The three checks match the repair you performed, not a generic list.
- Any issue they report routes to your normal callback process, not into the email thread.

Guardrails

Treat the output as a draft and keep a human approval step. The check-in offers a look within the warranty you actually provide — never let a generated email extend, imply, or reinterpret warranty terms.



Workflow 6 — Review request: the 14-day asker

A two-touch review request that lands 14 days after a completed repair: a day-14 text, and a day-21 email only if the text was missed. Estimated time to run: about 6 minutes per request.

Reviews are won by timing and specificity, not enthusiasm. Fourteen days out, the repair still works, the memory is fresh, and the ask takes the homeowner less time than the coffee order.

The tool

ChatGPT or Claude; the text goes out from whatever number or system your shop already uses with customers.

How to run it

1. Open the prompt 14 days after the repair closed.
2. Paste the tech's first name and a one-sentence repair detail.
3. Add your Google Business Profile short link — the real one from your own listing.
4. Send the text that morning; if there is no review by day 21, send the email version written from the same prompt with "email" swapped in.

The prompt

PROMPT — 14-day review ask

You are a plumbing service manager running the 14-day review ask. Generate a 3-sentence SMS under 160 characters for the homeowner below. Sentence 1: thanks for the visit 14 days ago, naming the repair. Sentence 2: a short ask for a brief Google review that mentions [TECH NAME] and the one specific repair detail ([REPAIR DETAIL] — a fill-valve swap, a trap install, a leak pinpoint). Sentence 3: the Google Business Profile short link. No exclamation points, no urgency, no incentives. Homeowner: [HOMEOWNER FIRST NAME]. Tech: [TECH NAME]. Repair: [REPAIR DETAIL]. Short URL: [GMB SHORT URL].



What you get

A 160-character ask that names your tech and the actual work — the two details that make reviews read as real — and lands the homeowner on your listing in one tap.

Worked example

"Hi Tom, thanks for having us out for the trap install two weeks back. If [your tech] took good care of you, a quick Google review mentioning him and the trap work helps the next neighbor find us: [your short link]." Sent once, at day 14, in the morning. If it is missed, the day-21 email repeats the ask once — and then you stop. Two touches total, never a drip campaign.

Before you send

- The job closed happy. Never run this prompt on a job with an open complaint, a pending callback, or a billing dispute.
- The short link is your own verified Google Business Profile link — test it before you send.
- The tech named is the tech who did the work.

Guardrails

Treat the output as a draft and keep a human approval step. Never offer anything in exchange for a review, never ask for a specific star rating, and never send more than the two touches. Review platforms and regulators both treat that as manipulation — and homeowners can smell it.



Workflow 7 — Repipe estimate: the multi-day project quote

A one-step prompt that turns a repipe assessment — home square footage, pipe material, fixture count — into a fixed-price multi-day project quote with the three phases laid out day by day. Estimated time to run: about 25 minutes per quote, most of it your review of the buckets.

A repipe is the biggest check most homeowners will ever write you. The proposal has to read like a plan, not a number: what happens each day, what the buckets cover, what is warranted, and what you check at day 60.

The tool

ChatGPT or Claude, at the kitchen-table review after the assessment, or back at the office the same day.

How to run it

1. Open the prompt at the kitchen-table review after the repipe assessment.
2. Paste home square footage, existing pipe material, fixture count, and access notes.
3. Add your bucket totals from your own estimating sheet — labor, material, drywall patch, permit, project management.
4. Cut the output into your project-proposal form, then read it once as the homeowner before it is signed.

The prompt

PROMPT — Multi-day repipe proposal

You are a plumbing service manager pricing a full-home repipe. Below is the assessment. Generate the proposal as four blocks: (1) a one-paragraph project description a homeowner can sign off on — cut-out, dry-run, patch, paint, and the one option we recommend for the existing [PIPE MATERIAL]; (2) line-item totals in FIVE buckets (labor, material, drywall patch, permit, project management) using only the totals I give you — no vendor line items, no invented figures; (3) the 3 phases laid out day by day (cut-out and rough-in: days 1–2, fixture set: day 3, drywall and patch: day 4) with one yes/no question about whether the family will be in the home during the work; (4) a warranty line matching the terms I give you, and the one follow-on check the tech will perform at 60 days (a pressure-test final, a leak-detector install verification, or an insulation wrap check). Numbers, no narrative filler. Assessment: [PASTE NOTES]. Bucket totals: [LABOR], [MATERIAL], [PATCH], [PERMIT], [PM]. Warranty: [YOUR WARRANTY TERMS].

What you get

A four-block proposal a homeowner can understand at one reading: what you will do, what it costs by bucket, what each day looks like, and what stands behind the work at day 60.

Worked example

Assessment: 1,600 sq ft ranch, galvanized supply lines, 9 fixtures, good attic access. Block 1 describes the job in plain words and recommends the replacement material for galvanized. Block 2 carries your five bucket totals — yours, from your sheet, not the AI's. Block 3 lays out days 1–2 cut-out and rough-in, day 3 fixture set, day 4 drywall and patch, and asks whether the family will be home. Block 4 states your actual warranty and the 60-day pressure-test final. The homeowner signs a plan, not a guess.

Before you send

- Every bucket total traces to your estimating sheet. If a number is not in your notes, it does not appear in the proposal.
- The day-by-day phases reflect your real crew capacity — not the optimistic version.
- Permit handling matches how your jurisdiction actually works and who pulls it.



Guardrails

Treat the output as a draft and keep a human approval step. Never let a generated proposal promise a completion date, a permit timeline, or a warranty your shop does not put in writing on its own contracts. If the existing pipe material raises a health or code question, that conversation is yours, in person, before any paper.

The week-one quick start

You do not need all seven workflows running to get value from this book. You need one, running this week, on real jobs.

Pick your first workflow

- After-hours calls run your life start with Workflow 1, the emergency dispatch.
- You price water heaters at the table start with Workflow 2, the three-tier quote.
- You have plan customers you never touch start with Workflow 3, the spring cadence.
- Your diagnosed jobs drift to competitors start with Workflow 4, the same-day report.
- Everything else chains behind it: the 30-day check-in (Workflow 5) and the 14-day asker (Workflow 6) run off every closed job, and the repipe proposal (Workflow 7) is there when the big one lands.

Which prompt, when

- The phone rings after hours Workflow 1 prompt.
- The water heater is older than the warranty Workflow 2 prompt.
- Spring is six weeks out and plans are coming due Workflow 3 prompt.
- You found the cause and quoted the fix Workflow 4 prompt, same day.
- A closed job just turned 30 days old Workflow 5 prompt.
- A closed job just turned 14 days old Workflow 6 prompt.
- The assessment says whole-house Workflow 7 prompt.

Three bonus prompts for the gaps

Day-before schedule confirm. "You are a plumbing dispatcher confirming tomorrow's visit. Generate a text under 160 characters that names the date, the arrival window, and the one thing to have ready ([ACCESS ITEM] — clear access to the shutoff, the water heater, or the cleanout; pets secured). Close with one yes/no confirm question. Homeowner: [FIRST NAME]. Date: [DATE]. Window: [WINDOW]. No exclamation points."

Missed-appointment recovery. "You are a plumbing service manager recovering a missed appointment without blaming the homeowner. Generate a 3-sentence text: sentence 1 owns the miss plainly; sentence 2 offers two specific new windows I give you; sentence 3 asks for one yes/no on the first window. Homeowner: [FIRST NAME]. New windows: [WINDOW A], [WINDOW B]. Tone: accountable, no excuses, no exclamation points."

Review reply. "You are the owner of a plumbing shop replying to a Google review. Generate a reply under 60 words that thanks the reviewer by first name, names the specific job detail from the review ([JOB DETAIL]), and invites them back for the next need — no discount, no offer, no defensiveness. If the review is negative, acknowledge the specific complaint, state the one corrective step already taken, and give the direct phone number to reach me. Review: [PASTE REVIEW]."

The standing guardrails, on one page

- AI drafts; you decide. Nothing goes to a customer unread by you.
- Your numbers, only. Prices, fees, dates, and warranty terms come from your sheet, your calendar, and your contracts — never from the tool.
- First names and job details only in prompts. No payment details, no passwords, no government identifiers, nothing you would not read aloud.
- Treat every output as a draft with a human approval step, and keep the source notes with the final draft.

Run one workflow this week and count the evening hours you get back. That is the whole test.

Thank you for putting this book to work. If a workflow in here saves your shop real hours, the best thank-you is a review that names what it did for you — and if one falls flat on a real job, we want to hear that too.

— SkillForge AI